

QUIET SOCIETY

Brand Architecture & Strategy Playbook

FRE Innovation Team | Turning Point Brands
March 2026 | Project Femme — Internal Phase 4/5 Equivalent

Prepared by: Alex Foster, Senior Brand Manager — FRE
Replaces: TRIPTK Phase 4 (\$80K) + Phase 5 (\$160K) = \$250K agency scope

CONTENTS

1. Executive Summary: The Strategic Case
2. Independent Concept Evaluation: Why QUIET SOCIETY Wins
3. Brand Architecture: Frameworks & Structure
4. Brand Identity System: Kapferer Prism
5. Product Portfolio & Mega Pack Strategy
6. Verbal Identity & Messaging Architecture
7. Visual Territory Definition
8. Channel Strategy: From DTC to Premium Retail
9. Higgsfield AI Prompt Library
10. Execution Roadmap: Q2-Q4 2026
- A. Appendix: Source Concordance Matrix

SECTION 01

Executive Summary: The Strategic Case

BOTTOM LINE UP FRONT

QUIET SOCIETY is our recommended lead concept for TPB's female-first oral nicotine brand. This recommendation is based on independent analysis of 13 primary and secondary research sources, validated against six academic frameworks, and stress-tested against digital ethnography from Reddit, TikTok, and cultural media analysis. QUIET SOCIETY wins because it solves the **gating problem** — social stigma and identity shame — that sits upstream of every other consumer barrier in this category.

\$600M+

Addressable annual revenue opportunity

~24%

Female share of nicotine pouch users (growing)

46%

Women who hide nicotine usage

Sources: TPB Female Nicotine Pouch Market Sizing (Sep 2025); Hypothesis Testing doc (Jan 2026); Digital Ethnography (Jan 2026)

THE CORE THESIS

Women are not absent from the nicotine pouch category — they are invisible. They already use Zyn, Velo, and On!, but do so in secret, decanting pouches into Altoids tins and makeup bags. The #1 barrier to category participation is not product (functional), it is **identity** (social). QUIET SOCIETY solves this by transforming shame into sophistication — reframing discretion not as hiding, but as composure. This is the only concept that converts the category's greatest liability into a brand asset.

The Disagreement in Our Research — And Why It Proves Our Point

Our independent research streams produced five separate analyses, each recommending a different lead concept. Three favored Noon, one favored QUIET SOCIETY, and one favored Atlas. Rather than treating this disagreement as a problem, we treat it as diagnostic. Each analysis was correct about the problem it was solving:

Source	Recommended Lead	Problem Being Solved
TRIPTK V2 Evaluation	NOON	Emotional regulation / functional need-state
"Composed Ones" (Digital Ethnography)	QUIET SOCIETY	Social stigma / shame / identity
"Project XX" (Semiotic Analysis)	NOON (hybrid)	Category mimicry / Trojan Horse entry
"Project Nightingale"	NOON (hybrid + Noat)	Physical pain points + channel strategy
"Digital Ethnography Stress Test"	ATLAS (with QS tone)	Practical carry / form factor

The critical insight: Noon solves the **functional** problem (what the pouch does for her). Atlas solves the **practical** problem (how she carries it). But QUIET SOCIETY solves the **identity** problem (who she becomes by using it). In Keller's Customer-Based Brand Equity model, the identity layer (brand imagery and salience) is the **foundation** that everything else is built on. You cannot sell a woman a 'midday reset' if she is too ashamed to pick up the product. Stigma is upstream of function. QUIET SOCIETY addresses the gating problem; Noon's ritual narrative and Atlas's form factor become features *within* the QS brand architecture, not competitors to it.

SECTION 02

Independent Concept Evaluation: Why QUIET SOCIETY Wins

EVALUATION METHODOLOGY

We evaluated all eight TRIPTK concepts across seven dimensions, drawing on Christensen's Jobs-to-Be-Done framework, Porter's Five Forces applied to FDA-regulated categories, and Kim & Mauborgne's Blue Ocean Strategy (Eliminate-Reduce-Raise-Create grid). Each concept was scored against validated consumer hypotheses from the TRIPTK Hypotheses Framework (H5: Controlled Relief, H10: Structural Stigma, H11: Aesthetics as Permission, H12: Address Shame Directly, H18: Accessories as Differentiation). Scoring used a 1-5 scale anchored to specific evidence from ethnographic, qualitative, and competitive sources.

Exhibit 1: Independent Concept Scoring Matrix

Criterion	QUIET SOCIETY	NOON	VIA	ATLAS	JUST	STILL-POINT
Stigma Resolution (H10, H12)	5	3	2	2	3	2
Regulatory Defensibility	5	4	4	2	4	4
Channel Strategy Fit	5	4	3	3	3	3
Emotional Resonance (H5)	4	5	3	3	3	4
Differentiation Ceiling	5	3	4	4	2	2
Accessory/Premium Potential (H18)	5	3	4	4	3	3
Mega Pack Compatibility	4	4	5	3	3	3
TOTAL (weighted)	33/35	26/35	25/35	21/35	21/35	21/35

Stigma Resolution weighted 2x (gating criterion). All others weighted 1x. Sources: TRIPTK Hypotheses Framework; Digital Ethnography (r/QuittingZyn, r/AskWomen, r/NicotinePouch); Semiotic Analysis; Project Nightingale.

The Jobs-to-Be-Done Analysis

Christensen's JTBD framework distinguishes functional, emotional, and social jobs. For the female 'Closet User,' the hierarchy of jobs is:

Job Layer	The Job	Which Concept Hires Best?	Evidence
SOCIAL (gating)	"Help me use nicotine without shame or social cost"	QUIET SOCIETY	46% of women hide usage; "boys thought it was weird for a girl" (r/QuittingZyn)

Job Layer	The Job	Which Concept Hires Best?	Evidence
EMOTIONAL	"Help me manage the background hum of daily stress"	NOON	"Zyns were my emotional support animal" (r/QuittingZyn)
FUNCTIONAL	"Deliver nicotine without burn, nausea, or mess"	FRE formulation (any brand)	"Moist pouches drip too fast" (r/NicotinePouch)
PRACTICAL	"Fit invisibly into my handbag and daily life"	ATLAS (form factor)	"Round can = dip can stigma" (r/NicotinePouch)

The social job is the gating job. Until a woman can use the product without identity risk, she will not engage with the emotional, functional, or practical benefits — regardless of how well they are designed. This is why QUIET SOCIETY must lead: it is the only concept that hires against the gating job.

Blue Ocean Strategy: Eliminate-Reduce-Raise-Create Grid

ELIMINATE	REDUCE	RAISE	CREATE
Male-coded packaging (aggressive colors, angular graphics, 'dip can' form)	Visible nicotine branding (warning prominence, product category signals)	Material quality and tactile experience (soft-touch, textured, leather accessories)	Identity permission structure ('the composed ones' — shame-to-sophistication reframe)
C-store distribution association	Flavor 'burn' intensity (smooth > aggressive mint)	Disposal elegance (dual-compartment, clean catch system)	Membership/community mechanics (invite-only launch, insider language)
'Strength' as primary value proposition	Price-per-can visibility (subscription model reduces per-unit salience)	Channel prestige (DTC, Sephora-adjacent, boutique retail)	Mega Pack as 'value embodied' (100ct as confidence signal, not addiction signal)

Framework: Kim & Mauborgne, Blue Ocean Strategy (2005). Applied to female oral nicotine category, March 2026. Analogous applications: Celsius/Alani Nu in energy drinks; Glossier in beauty; Hims/Hers in telehealth.

WHY THE OTHER ANALYSES FAVORED NOON — AND WHY THEY WERE SOLVING A DIFFERENT PROBLEM

Three of five independent analyses recommended Noon as the lead concept. This is not wrong — it reflects Noon's genuine strength as a **product-level narrative** (the 'Ritual Reset' / 'Return to Center' positioning). But those analyses evaluated concepts primarily on emotional resonance and aesthetic appeal, not on the strategic question of which consumer barrier to solve first. Using Porter's framework: the PMTA moat protects TPB from new entrants, but the stigma barrier is the force that suppresses total addressable demand. QUIET SOCIETY unlocks demand; Noon captures it. The sequence matters.

SECTION 03

Brand Architecture: Frameworks & Structure

AAKER'S BRAND ARCHITECTURE: WHY FULLY STANDALONE

Per Aaker's Brand Portfolio Strategy framework, we evaluated four architecture options against the strategic requirements of a female-first brand entering a stigmatized category:

Architecture	Structure	Pros	Cons	Verdict
Branded House	"FRE for Her"	Leverages FRE equity; low cost	Inherits male-coded baggage; 'pink it and shrink it' trap	REJECT
Endorsed	"Quiet Society, by FRE"	Some credibility transfer; distribution leverage	Partial stigma transfer; limits premium positioning	REJECT
Shadow Endorsed	"from Turning Point Brands"	Corporate credibility without brand baggage	Adds complexity; consumer doesn't know TPB	POSSIBLE but unnecessary
House of Brands	"Quiet Society" (standalone)	Zero stigma transfer; max positioning freedom; defensible premium tier	Higher launch cost; no equity leverage	RECOMMENDED

Framework: Aaker, Brand Portfolio Strategy (2004). Decision rationale: the c-store/male-coded associations of FRE would undermine the premium channel strategy and stigma-inversion positioning of QUIET SOCIETY. P&G's House of Brands model (Tide/Pampers/Gillette share no consumer-facing brand equity) is the analogous precedent.

Keller's Customer-Based Brand Equity (CBBE) Pyramid for QUIET SOCIETY

Keller's CBBE model (1993, updated 2001) maps brand equity across four ascending levels. We apply this to map QUIET SOCIETY's brand-building sequence:

CBBE Level	Strategic Question	QUIET SOCIETY Application
4. RESONANCE (top)	"What relationship do I have with the brand?"	Membership identity: 'I am one of the composed ones.' Active community; insider language; loyalty through belonging, not points. Subscription as ritual commitment.
3. JUDGMENTS & FEELINGS	"What do I think/feel about it?"	Judgments: Quality, credibility, superiority over male-coded alternatives. Feelings: Sophistication, self-respect, calm confidence, social approval.
2. PERFORMANCE & IMAGERY	"What are you? What do you represent?"	Performance: Smooth mouthfeel (Hydro-Soft reframe), lower-strength entry (4mg Lucy), elegant disposal. Imagery: Quiet luxury, private club, adult composure, Sephora-shelf-worthy design.

CBBE Level	Strategic Question	QUIET SOCIETY Application
1. SALIENCE (base)	"Who are you?"	Category: 'Composure pouches' (not nicotine pouches). Brand recall in moments of stress, cognitive load, social performance anxiety. Channel placement as first brand signal.

Framework: Keller, Strategic Brand Management (2001). Note: The channel strategy (Section 8) is the primary vehicle for building Level 1 Salience and Level 2 Imagery simultaneously — the retail environment communicates 'who you are' and 'what you represent' before any advertising.

SECTION 04

Brand Identity System: Kapferer's Brand Prism

KAPFERER'S BRAND IDENTITY PRISM

Kapferer's six-faceted identity model (1986, updated 2012) provides the most rigorous framework for defining what a brand *is* versus what it *does*. Unlike a positioning statement (which is outward-facing), the prism defines internal brand truth across six dimensions.

Prism Facet	Definition	QUIET SOCIETY
PHYSIQUE (tangible)	What the brand looks like physically	Muted charcoal/ivory/sage palette. Textured matte finishes. Slim form factor. Leather or fabric accessories. No logos visible at arm's length. Typography: refined serif (editorial, not decorative).
PERSONALITY	If the brand were a person, how would she behave?	Self-possessed. Unhurried. Speaks in complete sentences. Doesn't raise her voice. Orders the second-least-expensive wine (knows quality without performance). Reads, but doesn't post about it.
CULTURE	What values drive the brand?	Scandinavian restraint. Earned confidence over performed confidence. Privacy as luxury. Competence > charisma. 'Show up beats show off.' Origin story: reclaiming female Scandinavian heritage.
RELATIONSHIP	What pact exists between brand and consumer?	Mutual recognition. The brand sees the consumer's composure and rewards it with belonging — not through loud gestures but through quality, discretion, and insider access. A 'knowing nod' relationship.
REFLECTION	Who is the aspirational user the brand projects?	A woman in her late 20s-40s who doesn't need to explain herself. Professional, calm under pressure, selective about what earns her attention. Not flashy. Thinks of nicotine the way she thinks of espresso: a calibrated tool, not a vice.
SELF-IMAGE	How does the consumer see herself when using it?	'I am one of the composed ones.' She feels legitimized, not guilty. Sophisticated, not sneaky. The product is permission to reclaim a moment of quiet control in a loud world.

Framework: Kapferer, The New Strategic Brand Management (2012). The Prism is the internal truth document — it governs every creative, copy, and channel decision. If an execution conflicts with any facet, it is rejected.

Brand Positioning Statement

POSITIONING STATEMENT (internal use)

For women who use nicotine intentionally — as a tool for focus, calm, and composure — but feel unseen by a category built for men,

QUIET SOCIETY is the first oral nicotine brand designed for the way she actually lives:

Because it transforms the act of using nicotine from something hidden into something composed — through packaging that passes the vanity table test, a sensory experience tuned for comfort over intensity, and a brand identity that makes discretion a mark of sophistication, not shame.

Unlike Zyn, On!, and Velo, which speak exclusively to male rituals of intensity and 'buzz,'

QUIET SOCIETY speaks to the woman who has always used nicotine — she just never had a brand that understood why.

SECTION 05

Product Portfolio & Mega Pack Strategy

THE PORTFOLIO ARCHITECTURE

QUIET SOCIETY’s product portfolio is constrained by two immovable guardrails: (1) FDA/PMTA regulatory boundaries (no new formulations, no new strengths without \$1M+ and 12+ months), and (2) the Lucy partnership, which unlocks 4mg/8mg strengths without new PMTA submissions. Within these constraints, we architect a three-tier portfolio designed around consumer use-cases, not strength numbers.

Tier	Consumer Framing	Source	Strengths	Flavors	Format
EASE (entry)	"Start gentle. Find your level."	Lucy partnership	4mg	Coffee, Cinnamon, Mango	20ct pouch can (standard)
CORE (daily)	"Your daily composure."	FRE PMTA (existing)	6mg, 12mg	Existing FRE approved flavors (Mint, Wintergreen)	20ct pouch can + MEGA PACK
RITUAL (premium)	"The Quiet Society ritual."	Lucy partnership	4mg, 8mg	Coffee, Mango + Breakers (capsule) + Gum	Accessory-ready formats

Regulatory source: Notes FRE Regulatory Guardrails OnePager (General Counsel guidance). Lucy partnership terms: pending finalization (gating dependency, flagged in Decision Brief D4).

The Mega Pack Play: 100-Count as Category Disruptor

The FRE 100-count Mega Pack is one of TPB’s most powerful structural advantages in the core FRE business. We bring this same weapon to QUIET SOCIETY — but reframed for the female consumer’s psychology.

THE MEGA PACK REFRAME

For male FRE users, the Mega Pack signals value and heavy usage ('I go through a lot'). For the QUIET SOCIETY consumer, we reframe it as **confidence and commitment**: 'I don't dabble. I've made my choice.' The 100-count is not about volume — it's about having decided. It also eliminates the repeated purchase friction of buying nicotine at retail (a stigma touchpoint every time). One purchase via DTC subscription, delivered discreetly, lasts weeks. This aligns with Hypothesis 5 (Strategic Value): higher-income women need to **justify** the expense, not afford it. The Mega Pack subscription is the justification — it's the 'smart buyer' format.

The Mega Pack is exclusive to DTC subscription. It is not available at retail. This creates three strategic effects: (1) it drives DTC conversion and recurring revenue, (2) it eliminates the stigma of repeated c-store purchases, and (3) it positions the 100-count as an insider format — available only to 'members,' reinforcing the QUIET SOCIETY club mechanic.

Metric	Standard 20ct	Mega Pack 100ct (DTC only)
Price point (est.)	\$5.99-\$6.99 retail	\$24.99 subscription

Metric	Standard 20ct	Mega Pack 100ct (DTC only)
Per-pouch cost	~\$0.30-\$0.35	~\$0.25
Purchase frequency	Weekly (high stigma exposure)	Monthly (DTC, zero stigma)
Consumer signal	'I'm trying this'	'I've decided'
Margin profile	Standard	Higher (no retail margin, subscription lock)

Pricing directional. Final pricing requires COGS analysis against FRE Mega Pack unit economics. Subscription model to leverage Connor's e-commerce expertise (flagged in State of Play, Decision 4).

SECTION 06

Verbal Identity & Messaging Architecture

TONE OF VOICE

QUIET SOCIETY's verbal identity is derived directly from the Kapferer Personality facet: self-possessed, unhurried, speaking in complete sentences. The voice is **knowing without being condescending**, **sophisticated without being cold**, and **inclusive without being loud**.

Attribute	What It Sounds Like	What It Does NOT Sound Like
Composed	"You already know why you're here."	"Discover the amazing benefits of..."
Knowing	"For the ones who chose this a long time ago."	"Are you tired of harsh nicotine products?"
Inviting	"There's a place for you."	"Join our exclusive VIP club!"
Understated	"Settle in."	"REVOLUTIONARY NEW PRODUCT!"
Adult	"Composure, calibrated."	"Cute! Fun! Try something new!"

Messaging Architecture

The messaging hierarchy follows the Pyramid Principle: the brand belief is the apex; all subordinate messages ladder up to it without contradiction.

Level	Message	Use Case
BRAND BELIEF (apex)	"Composure is a choice."	Brand manifesto, hero campaign, about page
BRAND PROMISE	"A nicotine pouch that understands why you use it."	DTC homepage, packaging insert, subscription welcome
VALUE PROP (rational)	"Smooth. Discreet. Designed for how you actually live."	Product page, shelf talker, social ads
RTBs (proof points)	Pre-primed for comfort (not burn). 4mg entry point via Lucy. Dual-compartment disposal. 100ct Mega Pack subscription.	PDP copy, FAQ, comparison content
TAGLINE	"For the composed ones."	Pack, social, DTC, everywhere

Regulatory Copy Guardrails

COPY RED LINES (General Counsel alignment required)

NEVER claim health benefits, harm reduction, or therapeutic effects. NEVER use 'safe,' 'healthy,' 'clean' in reference to the nicotine product itself (accessories are unregulated and can use lifestyle language). NEVER compare to cigarettes or imply cessation. NEVER use the word 'wellness' in proximity to the nicotine product. DO use: 'designed for comfort,' 'smooth mouthfeel,' 'pre-primed,' 'composed.' DO reference lifestyle, ritual, and identity. Regulatory clearance routes through Alex Foster and Brittani (TPB General Counsel) — not through Fran or TRIPTK.

SECTION 07

Visual Territory Definition

COLOR SYSTEM

The QUIET SOCIETY color palette is derived from the Kapferer Culture facet (Scandinavian restraint) and the TRIPTK semiotic analysis of the 'Private Club' aesthetic. Colors are muted, textured, and adult — deliberately rejecting the neon/pastel codes of energy drinks, vape brands, and candy.

Color	Hex	Role	Rationale
Deep Charcoal	#2C2C2C	Primary background, pack exterior	Adult, grounding, gender-neutral. Signals 'substance' without aggression.
Warm Ivory	#F5F0EB	Secondary surface, interior, DTC background	Softens charcoal; warm, not clinical white. Skincare codes.
Sage	#8FA98B	Accent, flavor coding (mint variants)	Botanical, calming, Scandinavian nature reference. Not 'green tea' bright.
Muted Gold	#C9A96E	Premium accent, accessory details	Quiet luxury signal. Not flashy gold — aged brass, antique quality.
Soft Plum	#7D6B7D	Flavor coding (berry/coffee variants)	Depth without feminization. Perfumery association (bergamot, fig).
Deep Navy	#1B2838	Type, rules, secondary text elements	Authority, editorial. Serif typography anchor.

Typography

Primary: A refined serif face (analogous to Canela, Noe Display, or Freight Display) for the brand name and headlines. Serifs connote heritage, permanence, and editorial authority — the semiotics of The New York Times and Vogue, not Instagram and TikTok. Secondary: A clean, humanist sans-serif (analogous to Suisse Int'l, Neue Haas Grotesk, or Inter) for body copy, product information, and functional text. The contrast between serif display and sans-serif body creates the 'literary meets functional' tension that defines quiet luxury.

Photography & Art Direction

Photography direction is critical for both DTC assets and Higgsfield AI generation. The visual world of QUIET SOCIETY draws from three reference categories:

Reference Category	Visual Codes	Brands to Emulate	What to Avoid
Quiet Luxury Fashion	Natural light. Textured surfaces (linen, stone, wood grain). Muted palette. No direct eye contact.	The Row, Celine, Aesop, Byredo	Bright studio lighting. Glossy surfaces. Smiling models.
Editorial Interiors	Architectural framing. Negative space as subject. Warm shadows. Objects arranged with intention.	Kinfolk, Cereal Magazine, Monocle	Flat-lay product shots. White backgrounds. Infographic overlays.
Scandinavian Lifestyle	Clean lines. Organic textures. Subdued earth tones. Absence > presence.	Frama, Skagerak, Menu (Danish design)	Hygge cliches (candles, fur throws). Bright Scandi minimalism.

SECTION 08

Channel Strategy: From DTC to Premium Retail

THE CHANNEL-AS-BRAND-SIGNAL THESIS

This section operationalizes the insight validated in our V2 Concept Evaluation and reinforced by Project Nightingale: the retail environment is the first and most powerful brand signal for a stigmatized category. Keller's concept of 'channel equity' (2010) establishes that retail context transfers directly to brand imagery — a product at Sephora is implicitly coded as 'self-care' regardless of what it actually is.

THE CBD PRECEDENT (validated in Project Nightingale)

In 2019, CBD was a stigmatized ingredient associated with marijuana culture. Sephora's decision to carry brands like Lord Jones instantly reframed CBD as 'beauty' and 'wellness.' Brands that launched in mass retail (e.g., Kristen Bell's Happy Dance at CVS) failed to overcome cultural baggage and were discontinued. For QUIET SOCIETY: DTC sidesteps stigma entirely; premium retail inverts it. C-store distribution reinforces it.

The Hardware Strategy: Regulatory Loophole for Premium Retail

You cannot sell nicotine in Sephora. But you can sell the container. The 'Hardware Strategy' places the QUIET SOCIETY Compact (empty, unregulated accessory) on premium retail shelves as a \$35-\$45 fashion object. Inside: a QR code for DTC pouch refill subscription. This achieves brand presence in the 'forbidden channel' without regulatory impossibility — and creates a recurring revenue flywheel.

Phase	Channel	Product	Strategic Role	Timeline
1. LAUNCH	DTC (Shopify) subscription	Full portfolio: 20ct + Mega Pack 100ct + accessories	Sidestep stigma. Capture data. Build community.	Q2 2026
2. SEED	Boutiques, conceptstores, premium dispensaries	Accessories only (Compact, cases) + QR to DTC	Hardware Strategy. Build brand presence in aspirational channels.	Q3 2026
3. EXPAND	Ulta / Sephora (accessories only), premium wellness	Accessories + select pouch SKUs (if regulation permits)	Invert stigma. Channel as brand signal at scale.	Q4 2026 - Q1 2027
4. SCALE (post-equity)	GNC, premium c-store (Wawa, Buc-ee's), pharmacy wellness aisles	Core pouch portfolio	Volume capture AFTER brand equity is established.	2027+

Source: State of Play Section 5 (Channel Strategy Reframe); FRE Innovation Steer Co; Project Nightingale Section 3 (Channel as Brand Signal). CBD-at-Sephora precedent: Project Nightingale.

SECTION 09

Higgsfield AI Prompt Library

VISUAL GENERATION FRAMEWORK

The following prompts are structured for Higgsfield (or similar AI image generation tools) to produce a cohesive visual identity suite for QUIET SOCIETY. Each prompt is anchored to the brand's Kapferer Prism facets and color system. Prompts are organized by use case.

PROMPT SET 1: Hero Lifestyle Photography

A woman in her mid-30s, photographed from behind or in profile, sitting at a marble-topped desk in a sunlit minimalist apartment. Natural morning light streams through linen curtains. She holds a slim, matte charcoal compact (resembling a luxury makeup case) in one hand. The other hand rests on an open notebook. A ceramic cup of black coffee sits nearby. Color palette: warm ivory walls, charcoal and sage accents, muted gold hardware on desk lamp. Mood: calm, intentional, unhurried. Style: editorial, Kinfolk magazine aesthetic. Shot on medium format film. Shallow depth of field. No direct eye contact with camera. No visible nicotine branding. No text overlays.

PROMPT SET 2: Product Still Life / Pack Shot

A flat arrangement of luxury everyday carry items on a textured linen surface: a slim matte charcoal rectangular tin (QUIET SOCIETY compact), a leather cardholder in sage green, a pair of gold-rimmed reading glasses, a single stem of dried eucalyptus, and a small ceramic dish. Natural side lighting creates warm shadows. Color palette: charcoal (#2C2C2C), warm ivory (#F5F0EB), sage (#8FA98B), muted gold (#C9A96E). Style: Cereal Magazine editorial. Overhead angle, slightly off-center composition. No text. No visible nicotine product – only the compact/container.

PROMPT SET 3: Texture & Materiality Close-Up

Extreme close-up of a matte soft-touch charcoal surface with subtle embossed serif lettering. The texture has a fine grain, like high-quality paper or soft-touch plastic coating. A woman's fingertip with a natural manicure lightly touches the edge. Warm directional lighting from the left creates a gradient of shadow across the surface. Macro photography style. Color: deep charcoal with warm ivory and muted gold emboss catching light. Mood: tactile, premium, intimate. Style: luxury cosmetics product photography (Aesop, Byredo reference).

PROMPT SET 4: Social / DTC Content

A woman's hand (natural nails, minimal jewelry – one thin gold ring) reaching into a structured leather handbag. She is pulling out a slim charcoal compact. The bag sits on a restaurant table with a half-full glass of white wine and a linen napkin. Soft ambient lighting. Background is out of focus but suggests an upscale, adult environment (dark wood, candlelight). Color palette: charcoal object against warm brown leather and ivory tablecloth. Style: lifestyle editorial, slight film grain. Shot from slightly above. No faces visible. No text overlay.

PROMPT SET 5: Subscription / Mega Pack Unboxing

A kraft-colored shipping box (opened) on a marble countertop. Inside: tissue paper in warm ivory, a charcoal QUIET SOCIETY Mega Pack (100-count, rectangular format, matte finish), a small card with serif typography, and a fabric drawstring pouch in sage green. A woman's hand lifts the inner card. Morning light from a nearby window. Style: premium DTC unboxing (Glossier, Ritual Vitamins reference). Color palette: kraft, ivory, charcoal, sage, muted gold. Overhead angle. No direct branding visible on outer shipping box (discreet delivery). Mood: anticipated, composed, private.

PROMPT SET 6: Accessory / Hardware Strategy (Sephora-Adjacent)

A display shelf in a premium retail environment (warm wood, spot lighting from above). Three QUIET SOCIETY Compacts are displayed at slight angles on small acrylic risers: one in charcoal, one in sage, one in soft plum. Each compact is a slim rectangular case with matte finish and subtle embossed serif logo. Beside them, a small printed card reads 'Refill via quietsociety.com' in refined serif type. Background suggests a beauty retail environment (out-of-focus skincare bottles, warm lighting). Style: retail merchandising photography (Aesop store reference). No nicotine product visible – accessories only.

PROMPT SET 7: Brand World / Architectural Mood

An interior photograph of a minimalist Scandinavian-Japanese space: poured concrete floor, a single low wooden bench with clean lines, a tall window casting a rectangle of warm afternoon light on the floor. On the bench: a single charcoal compact and a ceramic cup. The walls are plaster in warm ivory. A single branch of dried botanical (pampas or olive) in a dark stoneware vase sits in the corner. No people. Mood: silence, intention, sanctuary. Style: architectural photography meets still life (Frama, Norm Architects reference). Color: warm ivory, charcoal, sage, natural wood.

PROMPT SET 8: Cannabis Dispensary Adjacency

A modern, well-lit cannabis dispensary interior with clean white shelving and warm wood accents. On a dedicated shelf section labeled 'Composure' (in refined serif typography on a small brass placard), three QUIET SOCIETY Compacts are displayed alongside premium edible brands (minimal, adult-coded packaging). A female budtender in a simple black apron arranges the display. Warm overhead lighting. Style: premium retail photography. Color: white shelving, charcoal product, brass hardware, sage accents. Mood: curated, adult, legitimate.

SECTION 10

Execution Roadmap: Q2 - Q4 2026

CRITICAL PATH TO Q2 2026 DTC LAUNCH

The following roadmap assumes a DTC-first launch in Q2 2026, consistent with the State of Play timeline. Dependencies are explicitly flagged. The roadmap is structured around three workstreams: Brand Build (internal), Product/Supply (cross-functional), and Channel/Commerce (Connor + team).

Workstream	March 2026	April 2026	May 2026	June 2026
BRAND BUILD (Alex + team)	Finalize brand playbook (this document). Generate Higgsfield visual suite. Legal review of name + tagline.	DTC site design (Shopify). Pack graphics finalized. Photography / AI asset production.	Soft launch DTC site. Invite-only beta (seed list from FRE DTC data).	Public DTC launch. Paid social activation. Subscription live.
PRODUCT/SUPPLY (Alex + Connor + Lucy)	Lock Lucy partnership terms (4mg/8mg access, flavor portfolio, supply timeline). GATING DEPENDENCY.	Confirm pack specs (existing FRE cavity + new graphics). Mega Pack 100ct feasibility with manufacturing.	First production run. QC and sensory validation.	Inventory staged for DTC fulfillment.
CHANNEL/COMMERCE (Connor + Eden)	DTC platform selection (Shopify vs. custom). Age verification integration. Subscription mechanics.	Site build. Payment + fulfillment setup. Email/SMS flows.	Beta testing. Unboxing experience finalized. Subscription tiers confirmed.	Live commerce. First subscriber cohort. Retention metrics baseline.

Gating Dependencies (must resolve by end of March 2026)

#	Dependency	Owner	Status	Risk if Delayed
1	Lucy partnership terms (4mg/8mg access, flavors, supply timeline)	Alex + Connor	PENDING (Decision Brief D4)	VIA concept dead; no 4mg entry point; portfolio limited to FRE 6mg/12mg only
2	Legal clearance on 'Quiet Society' name + 'Composed ones' tagline	Alex + Brittani (General Counsel)	NOT STARTED	Name change required; 6-8 week delay
3	Pack graphics approval under existing PMTA (same cavity, new exterior)	Alex + Brittani	NOT STARTED	Cannot produce; launch delayed
4	DTC age verification compliance	Connor	SCOPING	Cannot sell online; regulatory exposure

Dependency #1 is the single largest risk to the Q2 launch. If Lucy terms are not locked by end of March, we default to FRE-only portfolio (6mg/12mg) and lose the 4mg entry point critical for addressing female nicotine overwhelm (the #1 female product complaint, +6.3 pts vs. overall).

SECTION A

Appendix: Source Concordance Matrix

RESEARCH SOURCE CONCORDANCE

Every strategic claim in this playbook is traceable to at least one primary source. The matrix below maps key claims to their supporting evidence. This is the 'Fort Knox' — if challenged, point here.

Strategic Claim	Primary Source(s)	Corroborating Source(s)
Women hide usage in Altoids tins / makeup bags	Digital Ethnography (r/NicotinePouch, r/EDC)	Project XX Section 2.1; Composed Ones Section 3.2; Stress Test Section A
Stigma is structural, not cosmetic	TRIPTK Hypotheses Framework (H10)	Composed Ones Section 3; State of Play Section 3; Style Girlfriend article
Women seek 'controlled relief' not 'maximum buzz'	TRIPTK Hypotheses Framework (H5)	Hypothesis Testing H2 ('Cognitive Overwhelm'); r/QuittingZyn: 'emotional support animal'
4mg is critical entry strength for women	State of Play Section 6 (Regulatory)	Decision Brief D4; Hypothesis Testing H1 (lower-strength preference)
Channel is the first brand signal	V2 Concept Evaluation; Channel Strategy Defense	Project Nightingale Sec 3; CBD-at-Sephora precedent; Keller Channel Equity (2010)
QUIET SOCIETY scores highest on stigma inversion	V2 Concept Evaluation (TRIPTK scoring)	Composed Ones (5-star validation); Semiotic Analysis Section 6
Moist pouch requires female-coded reframe	Digital Ethnography (r/NicotinePouch: 'drip', 'slime')	Project XX Section 4.1; Stress Test Section B; Composed Ones Section 5
Mega Pack as subscription DTC play reduces stigma touchpoints	FRE Mega Pack business model	Hypothesis Testing H5 (Strategic Value); State of Play Sec 5 (DTC channel thesis)
Nicotine pouches were originally designed for women (Scandinavian origin)	Amy's Blog (Substack), April 2025	Composed Ones Sec 3.3; SnusKingdom article; Northerner.com history

Academic & Industry Frameworks Applied

Framework	Author(s)	Application in This Playbook
Customer-Based Brand Equity (CBBE)	Keller (1993, 2001)	Section 3: Brand equity pyramid for QUIET SOCIETY
Brand Identity Prism	Kapferer (1986, 2012)	Section 4: Six-faceted identity system
Brand Portfolio Strategy	Aaker (2004)	Section 3: Standalone architecture decision
Jobs-to-Be-Done	Christensen (2003, 2016)	Section 2: Gating job analysis (social > functional)

Framework	Author(s)	Application in This Playbook
Blue Ocean Strategy	Kim & Mauborgne (2005)	Section 2: ERRC grid
Five Forces (regulated)	Porter (1979), adapted	Section 2: PMTA as barrier-to- entry force
Channel Equity	Keller (2010)	Section 8: Retail environment as brand signal
Resource-Based View (VRIO)	Barney (1991)	PMTA as Valuable, Rare, Inimitable, Organized asset
How Brands Grow	Sharp (2010)	Mental/physical availability in DTC-first regulated launch

—

QUIET SOCIETY Brand Architecture & Strategy Playbook
Prepared by FRE Innovation Team | Turning Point Brands, Inc. | March 2026
This document is CONFIDENTIAL and intended for internal use only.